

TOPIC 4: THE VISIT OF THE SHEPHERDS

1. The Account (Luke 2:8–20)

Shepherds were watching their flocks by night near Bethlehem. An angel of the Lord appeared and announced good news of great joy: a Saviour, Christ the Lord, had been born. A multitude of the heavenly host praised God. The shepherds went quickly to Bethlehem, found Mary, Joseph and the baby in the manger, and made known what they had been told. All who heard wondered; Mary treasured these things. The shepherds returned glorifying and praising God.

2. Significance

- The first to hear the good news were ordinary, humble shepherds – not the rich or powerful.
- The message is for all people (“good news of great joy for all the people”).
- Response of faith: the shepherds believed, went, saw and testified.

3. Lessons

God values the humble; we should respond promptly to God’s word; we should share the good news; worship and praise are proper responses to God’s salvation.

4. Summary

The shepherds received the angelic announcement of Jesus’ birth, found the child, and became the first human witnesses. Their story shows that the gospel is for everyone.

End of Topic 4